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Insurance & Prior Authorization Checklist

A step-by-step guide to verifying coverage and submitting prior authorization requests

Self-study practice document based on general health insurance basics. Processes differ by insurer and country, so always follow the payer's own requirements.

Phase 1: Before Contacting the Insurer

- ☐ Patient full name, date of birth, and member ID
- ☐ Insurance company name and group number
- ☐ Provider name, NPI, and clinic contact details
- ☐ Diagnosis code(s) and procedure or medication requested
- ☐ Supporting notes: prior treatments tried, lab results, clinical reason

Phase 2: During the Call or Portal Session

- ☐ Verify that coverage is active and note the effective dates
- ☐ Ask whether prior authorization is required and which form to use
- ☐ Ask about copay, deductible, and in-network requirements
- ☐ Record the reference number, representative name, date, and time
- ☐ Submit documents and confirm they were received

Phase 3: After Submission

- ☐ Note the expected decision timeline and set a follow-up reminder
- ☐ Inform the provider and the patient of the outcome
- ☐ If denied, flag it for the provider and gather appeal documents
- ☐ File all records securely, sharing only the minimum necessary information

Prior Authorization Tracker (fictional)

Patient	Service / Drug	Submitted	Reference #	Follow-up	Status
[Sample 1]	[item]	[date]	[number]	[date]	Pending
[Sample 2]	[item]	[date]	[number]	[date]	Approved
[Sample 3]	[item]	[date]	[number]	[date]	Denied: appeal

Practice project with fictional data. Created while studying health insurance basics.